The 6:15

FRIDAY · NOVEMBER 13, 2026 NO. 40

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Fri 11/13 (today)	October PPI, 8:30a ET — not yet released as of this writing **[not confirmed as of press time]**. SpaceX targeting Starship Flight 15, its first attempt to catch the ship with the tower **[NEW, single-sourced, same-day — outcome not yet known]**.
Tue 11/17	Nvidia reports Q3 FY27 — its first call under interim CEO Colette Kress. Also David Bednar's deadline to accept/decline the Yankees' $23.15M qualifying offer, unchanged from issue No. 39.
Tue 12/8–Wed 12/9	FOMC — no meeting falls inside this 10-day window.
Thu 12/10	November CPI, 8:30a ET.

OPEC+'s Nov. 29 meeting falls outside the window. New Glenn has slipped to January 2027 with no return-to-flight before year-end **[NEW]**. VC: OpenAI reportedly closed an $11B first tranche of a round at a $1.25T valuation, short of a $1.4T target **[flag, single-sourced, round not fully closed]**; Zipline raised $1.5B at a $21.5B post-money valuation **[NEW]**. Earnings calendar beyond Nvidia too thin to verify this run — omitted rather than padded.

METRICS

Equities (Thu. close)	Dow 52,297.09 (−0.36%); S&P 500 7,592.40 (−0.35%); Nasdaq Comp. 25,366.09 (−0.39%) — CNBC/Benzinga/StockTitan. The session Nvidia confirmed Huang's resignation
Equities (Wed. close)	S&P 500 +1.31% to 7,619.38; Nasdaq +1.6% to 25,466.19; Dow +0.49% (+254.60) to 52,486.49 — CoreWeave-led AI relief trade; Apple hit a record $5.16T market cap intraday
Equities (Tue. close)	S&P 500 +0.36% to 7,568.92; Dow −0.38% (−197.26) to 51,786.72; Nasdaq +0.83% to 25,372.01 **[flag, moderate confidence on date attribution]** — hot CPI session

Oil	Last confirmed settle Mon. 11/9: Brent $92.57 (−5.85%), WTI $86.85 (−4.38%). No Tue.–Thu. settle or Fri. premarket range found despite repeated searches **[not confirmed as of press time — a genuine four-day gap]**
Rates (Treasury.gov)	2Y/10Y/30Y — 11/9: 4.56/4.88/5.26. 11/10: 4.73/4.98/5.35. 11/12: 4.86/5.10/5.43 (no 11/11 row published; 11/13 not yet posted) — steady climb since Tuesday's CPI
VIX · Gold · DXY	No fresher reading than issue No. 39's (VIX ~19.9; gold $4,114.50 Mon. settle, +$39.60; DXY ~101.67) — 3–4 days stale **[flag]**
Asia · Europe	Last confirmed Tue. close: Nikkei 60,279.37 (+2.6%); Hang Seng 24,535.74 (+0.4%); Shanghai Comp. 3,663.72 (+0.08%); DAX 26,347.45 (+0.3%); CAC 8,278.59 (+0.6%). No Wed./Thu. closes confirmed **[flag, stale]**
Retail gas (AAA)	$3.98/gal nat'l avg. (~11/10), down from $4.0688 (11/6) and $4.0203 (11/8) **[NEW]**

HORMUZ COUNTERS — STRAITS.LIVE, DAY 257 OF CLOSURE

Diplomacy	Corrects No. 39: Qatar submitted its own competing 48-hr, two-stage plan Nov. 6 (IAEA inspections day one, Hormuz reopening day two) — a harder line than Iran's own offer. Trump said Nov. 10 that Gulf allies prefer the status-quo blockade **[DEVELOPING, corrects No. 39]**
Transits	No fresh IMF PortWatch pull. Secondary citation: October total 750 vs. Sept. 749, flat m/m but not comparable to the 85/day baseline **[flag, methodology mismatch]**
Dark tankers	straits.live last confirmed 53.8% (Nov. 4), now 9 days stale, no fresher pull found **[flag]**
Flows	No fresh Kpler figure. No. 39's 13.1M b/d remains single-sourced/unconfirmed **[flag]**

IRGC claims, UKMTO advisories, PortWatch's transit count, Kpler's flow estimate and straits.live's dark-tanker screen measure different things on different cadences and are never averaged or differenced here. None produced a confirmed fresh pull this run.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Bednar's decision due Tue. 11/17, not yet made. Chisholm non-tender stands.
Knicks	Tuesday's home game vs. Milwaukee result not independently confirmed this run **[not confirmed as of press time]**
Northwestern	3-7, unchanged. At Ohio State Sat. 11/14, 12:00p ET, on FOX — not yet played

LEAD

NVIDIA · SUCCESSION · CPI

Nvidia's board replaces Jensen Huang with CFO Colette Kress as a hot CPI print flips the market's rate bet from cut to hike

Nvidia confirmed Thursday that Jensen Huang has resigned as president, CEO and director, effective immediately — a sudden end to a 33-year tenure that made him the most recognizable executive in the AI buildout. The company's 8-K, filed with the SEC, names CFO Colette Kress interim CEO and independent director Harvey C. Jones the board's first-ever independent chair, with a search underway for a permanent successor from internal and external candidates. [fact, primary source: SEC 8-K] Nvidia gave no official reason for the departure. Press coverage (Axios, the Washington Post, NBC) has tied it to reporting from Nov. 8–9 that Huang's companion, Alice Huang, is assessed by US intelligence as a Chinese asset and may have used the relationship to target him — the matter issue No. 39 reported as an open board investigation. That framing is now superseded: this is a resignation, not an ongoing probe, though the board's own public silence on cause leaves open whether this was a negotiated exit or something closer to a forced one. [fact, multi-sourced on the departure; interpretation on cause]

The mechanism matters more than the personnel. Huang was not a figurehead CEO; he was, in a real sense, the narrative collateral behind the AI-capex trade — the person investors looked to for conviction that hyperscaler spending would keep translating into Nvidia revenue even as skepticism about capex payback has built since October. Removing that person abruptly, with no stated cause, and under a cloud of foreign-intelligence allegations, strips out a specific kind of reassurance at the exact moment the broader AI trade needed it least. [read] The stock reportedly fell as much as 13% intraday Thursday before paring losses, though no independently confirmed closing price surfaced this run **[not confirmed as of press time]** — a gap this brief would normally fill but can't, which is itself a signal of how fluid Thursday's trading was.

The second-order consequences run through two calendars. Nvidia now reports Q3 FY27 earnings Tuesday, Nov. 17 — Kress's first call as CEO, and the company's first chance to separate "is the AI-capex story intact" from "is Nvidia's leadership intact," two questions the market had been treating as one. Separately, House committee chairs have asked for a Huang briefing on Nvidia's relationship with Megaspeed, a request that predates Thursday's resignation and will now proceed without him in the CEO chair, changing its political texture. [fact] Whether Kress or Jones make any public remarks before the 17th will be an early tell on whether this becomes a controlled succession story or a crisis-management one.

That shock landed in the middle of a three-session whipsaw this brief can now reconstruct cleanly for the first time. Tuesday's October CPI ran hot — headline +0.4% month over month against roughly 0.3% expected, core +0.3% against roughly 0.2% expected — and pushed rate-path commentary from an assumed Fed hold toward live discus-

sion of a Dec. 8–9 hike; the Dow fell 0.38% that session even as CPI's deceleration from September's +0.6% kept the S&P narrowly positive. Wednesday reversed sharply: the S&P gained 1.31% and the Nasdaq 1.6% on a CoreWeave-led AI-infrastructure relief trade — CoreWeave's Q3 beat and raised full-year guidance read as evidence the capex-payback fear was overstated — and Apple touched a record $5.16 trillion market cap intraday. Thursday gave almost all of it back (S&P −0.35%, Nasdaq −0.39%) on the session Huang's exit became public. [fact] Read together, the three days show two unresolved tensions converging rather than resolving: a rates re-pricing toward higher-for-longer, and an idiosyncratic leadership shock at the single most important stock in the AI trade. Thursday's selling, concentrated on the day the resignation landed rather than spreading evenly across the week, suggests the market is treating Nvidia's leadership uncertainty as a risk distinct from the capex debate CoreWeave's print had just calmed — not a reason to re-open that debate, but a new, separate one. [read]

Watch: Thursday's actual NVDA close and any Kress/Jones public remarks before the 17th; today's PPI print against a CPI base that already moved the rate conversation; and whether Tuesday's earnings call becomes the venue where Nvidia tries to separate its leadership story from its capex story.

POLITICS

Kansas's governor's race remains uncalled. Holscher's lead over Masterson has reportedly widened to roughly 7,600 votes as of around Nov. 10, up from the 5,500–6,000 range reported in issues No. 38 and No. 39 **[flag, single-sourced, Axios]**. The secretary of state's close-race audit, covering six races including governor, is un-

derway; Johnson County completed a hand count of roughly 125,000 ballots around Nov. 9 and has stated the audit is distinct from a recount — if Masterson requests an actual recount, Johnson County says counting would begin Nov. 18. No AP call found this run. **[DEVELOPING, same status as issue No. 39]** The stakes of the margin: Kansas covers recount costs itself only if the final margin is within 0.5 percentage points, a threshold that bears on whether Masterson actually requests one rather than accepting the audit's result.

ECONOMICS

Beyond the Lead: October CPI's internals ran hotter in specific places than the headline alone suggests. Shelter rose 0.3% month over month and accounted for more than 30% of the total increase, per BLS; baby food and formula rose 5.1% month over month, the largest such increase since BLS began tracking roughly three decades ago. [fact, BLS primary] No year-over-year figure was published this cycle — the 2025 shutdown broke the index's base period — and one unnamed analyst's estimate of a roughly 4% implied year-over-year rate against 3.1% wage growth should be read as an analyst's estimate, not a BLS figure. **[flag]** October PPI is due today, 8:30 a.m. ET, and had not released as of this writing **[not confirmed as of press time]**. The next CPI release, covering November data, is scheduled for Dec. 10.

BUSINESS

CoreWeave's Q3 was the week's clearest beat: revenue of $3.661 billion, up 168% year over year, against consensus clustered near $3.54–3.55 billion, alongside a GAAP diluted loss of $1.27 a share.

[fact, primary source: CoreWeave investor release] The company raised full-year 2026 revenue guidance to $13.0–13.3 billion (from August's $12.4–13.2 billion), raised its exit-2026 annualized revenue-run-rate target to $20–21 billion, and disclosed a $132.5 billion backlog; adjusted EBITDA came in at $2.256 billion, a 62% margin. Shares rose as much as 8% after hours. Cisco closed the regular Thursday session at $102.01 (+1.24%) ahead of its print, then guided next quarter's adjusted EPS to $1.34–$1.36 on $18.0–18.2 billion revenue, both above LSEG consensus of $1.23/$17.88 billion — but its after-hours reaction was reported inconsistently across sources and this brief could not resolve which direction shares actually moved on the news itself **[flag]**. Applied Materials fell 3.58% to $380.95 in the regular session ahead of its own print, then beat and raised: non-GAAP EPS of $4.16 on $10.41 billion revenue against consensus of $4.06/$10.30 billion and against its own August guidance of $3.82–4.22/$9.75–10.75 billion; it raised full-year adjusted EPS guidance to $5.47–5.53. Its after-hours reaction was likewise reported inconsistently **[flag]**. Read together, both chipmakers printed clean beats-and-raises the same afternoon Nvidia's leadership news broke — a reminder that Thursday's broad-market selling was concentrated on Nvidia specifically rather than reflecting a reassessment of semiconductor fundamentals generally.

TECHNOLOGY

Beyond the Lead: Nvidia's board says it has no reason to believe trade secrets or national security were compromised, a position carried over from issue No. 39's reporting on the board probe that preceded Thursday's resignation; the company has not said whether that assessment changed. Congress's request for a Huang briefing on the Megaspeed relationship, noted in the Lead, is separate from the

board's own review and predates Thursday's news. [fact] One correction worth flagging on sourcing discipline: a widely circulated NBC report named incoming board chair Harvey Jones as interim CEO rather than CFO Colette Kress — Nvidia's own SEC filing and the majority of outlets confirm Kress holds the CEO title, with Jones chairing the board; this brief treats the Jones-as-CEO claim as an error rather than a second data point. [fact, primary source resolves the conflict] Elsewhere, OpenAI reportedly closed an $11 billion first tranche of a funding round valuing the company at $1.25 trillion, short of a reported $1.4 trillion target — wording that suggests the round is not yet fully closed **[flag, single-sourced]**. Zipline raised $1.5 billion at a $21.5 billion post-money valuation. **[NEW]** Several claimed frontier-model releases circulating this week were mutually inconsistent on what actually shipped and are not reported here for lack of a reliable primary source.

GEOPOLITICS

No standalone development beyond the Lead and Iran & Hormuz sections this issue.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Board: issue No. 39's framing of a single, converged Qatar-brokered proposal does not hold up against this run's research. Qatar's own plan, submitted Nov. 6, sets a harder sequence than Iran has offered — IAEA inspections on day one of a 48-hour window, Hormuz reopening only on day two — which means Doha is now a party proposing its own terms, not simply relaying an Iran-approved deal to Washington as previously reported. **[DEVELOPING, corrects No. 39]** Trump's Nov. 10 remarks that Gulf allies including Qatar and the UAE prefer keeping the blockade in place are a further reversal of the "truce imminent" read this brief carried two issues ago; he has repeated that strikes remain "highly unlikely" only if Iran fully reopens the strait and accepts a nuclear deal. Qatar's prime minister called talks with Trump and Vance "positive" without elaborating. Iran's Araghchi maintains the reopening offer "still stands," conditioned on what he calls seriousness from the other side. [fact, multi-sourced on the stalemate itself; specific deal terms remain single-sourced and unconfirmed] Worth restating against the current optimism-pessimism swings: a Qatar/Pakistan-brokered memorandum of understanding reached in June collapsed within weeks after a tanker attack in the strait — direct precedent for treating any renewed optimism cautiously until it survives contact with an actual Hormuz incident.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over. Bednar's decision due Tue. 11/17; Chisholm not tendered one.
Knicks	Tuesday's result vs. Milwaukee not independently confirmed this run; record not confirmed as of press time.
Northwestern	3-7. At Ohio State Sat. 11/14, 12:00p ET, on FOX — not yet played.

Continuity. Corrected this issue: issue No. 39's framing of a single, Iran-approved Qatari proposal — Doha is now understood to have submitted its own, harder-line plan, not merely carried Iran's terms. Superseded: the Nvidia "board investigation" framing from issue No. 39 is replaced by Thursday's actual resignation and CEO transition. Watch for next issue: Nvidia's actual Thursday close and any Kress/Jones remarks; today's PPI print; Tuesday's Nvidia earnings and Bednar deadline, same day; Kansas's audit/recount timeline; whether the Qatar-Iran term sheets converge or the talks collapse as June's did.

Unverified figures are marked in red: oil settles for Tue. 11/10 through Fri. 11/13 premarket; VIX, gold and DXY since Monday 11/9; Asia/Europe closes for Wed. 11/11 and Thu. 11/12; NVDA's actual Thursday close; Cisco's and Applied Materials' after-hours reaction direction; Kansas's updated margin (single-sourced, Axios); the Knicks-Milwaukee result and current record; PortWatch/Kpler/straits.live Hormuz figures (all stale, no fresh pull this run); OpenAI's funding-round completion status. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.